



Corssair Dominator XMS2 2GB DDR2 Kit 1066MHz 2x1024

Testing a newly-launched motherboard is a nightmare mostly because of memory compatibility issues; this is something we faced, and you'll face them too—till new BIOSes are introduced, of course.

Luckily, Corsair's Dominator memory worked flawlessly, and we recommend these if you plan to buy any of these motherboards. These memory modules are SPD programmed for 5-5-5-18 timings at 800 MHz, and do 5-5-5-15-2T at 1066MHz 2.2V. The 2 GB Dominator kit is a matched pair of 1 GB DDR2 memory modules—best used in dual-channel configuration.



overclocking through Windows, as also a utility to update the BIOS.

The ASUS and Gigabyte provide crash-free BIOSes. The MSI P35 Platinum has eight diagnostic LEDs and a BIOS reset switch—just in case. The Foxconn P35A provides onboard power and reset switches for fine-tuning the system before fitting.

Performance

Testing the boards resulted in mixed scores with only tiny differences. In PC Mark 05, a score of 7327 by the ASUS P5K Deluxe left the MSI P35 Platinum just behind at 7326. The Gigabyte GA-P35-DQ6 scored 10818 in 3D Mark 06, while ASUS P5K Deluxe

ran a score of 10813; the 10814 by the Foxconn P35A in 3D Mark 06 fetched it second position. In the SiSoft Processor Arithmetic and Multimedia test, the P5K Deluxe took the lead, while the Foxconn P35A a close second.

We used Corsair Dominator memory at 1066 MHz for our tests—no problems here. The Right Mark Memory Analyzer put the Gigabyte GA-P35-DQ6 ahead with a latency of 28.94 and a bandwidth of 4562.43.

The Asus P5K Deluxe was neck-to-neck with the Gigabyte, but lagged behind in the latency test with a score of 31.77 against the 28.94 of the GA-P35-DQ6. The ASUS P5K Deluxe completed Wprime in 32.859 seconds, followed by

Contact Sheet

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MSI	Micro Star International	011-41758808/09	sanyam@msi-india.com

Gigabyte at 32.937; in Super Pi, both scored 18.797 seconds.

In the gaming benchmarks, the Asus P5K Deluxe churned out 128.8 fps in *Company of Heroes*, the Gigabyte came in just behind with 128.1. The MSI P35 Platinum and Foxconn P35A clock 127.9 and 126.5 fps respectively.

The Foxconn P35A managed a score of 59.4 MBps in the Average Read test with a Random Access time of 64 ms in HD Tach. The Asus P5K Deluxe followed closely, but we saw a burst speed of 133.7 MBps. None of the boards really had a clear lead.

The Bundle

ASUS packs in a great bundle, with Wi-Fi and dual Gigabit LAN. The Q-Connector from ASUS simplifies installation of the chassis front panel connector by providing a pluggable, labelled connector.

The Foxconn P35A includes an SLI bridge in the package. The Gigabyte provides 4 eSATA 2 extensions along with

external power Molex for faster peripheral data transfer. All the boards come with a single FireWire port and SPDIF out (Sony/Philips Digital Interconnect Format); drivers for XP and Vista come bundled.

Our Conclusion

ASUS' new P5K Deluxe doesn't disappoint. Combining fabulous features, great overclocking potential, and superb performance, this new board is still reasonably priced.

The Gigabyte GA-P35-DQ6 is crafted beautifully, with superb on-paper specs, and it delivers—but at Rs 18,000, it's a little too expensive.

The MSI Platinum P35 is a good motherboard, especially by virtue of its pricing. Extensive (ab)use of copper for silent cooling and some component placement issues mar an otherwise great product.

The Foxconn P35A is an excellent product, but the over-the-head pricing is something Foxconn should consider revising.



← OnBoard Power and Reset switch: Benchtester Friendly



Foxconn P35A
Rs 15,000



Gigabyte P35-DQ6
Rs 18,900

Crazy Cool: enhances Heat desipation on rear side of Motherboard →

